

A slight distinction here; the inventory tracker and the price checker both will have their information converted to card style, but their displayed information is very different. And their initial display is also different. The inventory tracker shows the remaining inventory, while the price checker shows the items with some quantity recommended to be purchased.

Also, the cards are still tucked and displayed by expanding a header, which will be replaced by a card that displays the category name. For the inventory tracker, the names and icons are of the food groups. On the price checker, the category headers names and icons are based on their storage locations.

Perfect — this distinction is **exactly right** and it means your UX should treat Inventory Tracker and Price Checker as **siblings that share a visual language but not a layout purpose**.

Below is a refined, **app-wide card design strategy** that respects the functional differences you just described.

★ Key Distinction: Inventory Tracker vs Price Checker

✔ Inventory Tracker

Shows **what you have** and **how long it will last**.

- Quantity remaining
- Week-by-week usage timeline
- Consumption rate
- Zero-inventory hidden by default

✔ Price Checker

Shows **what you need to buy**, sorted by **recommended quantity**.

- "Recommended Purchase Qty"
- Price per unit & total price
- Monthly cost impact
- Store locations
- Active sales/coupons (optional)

✔ And both use cards, but the cards serve different roles.

So we now design **two card archetypes**:

1. **Inventory Card**
2. **Purchase Card** (Price Checker)

★ Category Headers Become Category Cards

You said:

"The cards are still tucked and displayed by expanding a header, which will be replaced by a card that displays the category name."

This is an excellent modernization.

✔ Category Card (collapsible)

Both screens start with **large category cards**:

Inventory Categories (Food Groups)

- Bread Cabinet
- Dairy
- Frozen Food
- Snacks
- Produce
- Meat
- Etc.

Price Checker Categories (Storage Locations)

- Pantry
- Freezer
- Refrigerator
- Bread Cabinet
- Cleaning Supplies
- Drinks Cabinet
- Bulk Storage Shelf

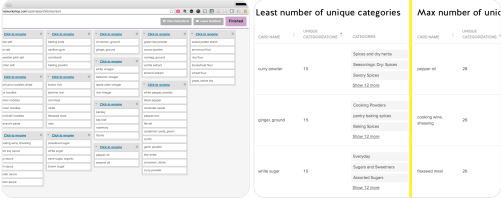
These are visually distinct and communicate context immediately.

★ Let's Design Each Screen Using These Rules

🎯 1. Inventory Tracker Layout

✦ Initial View

A vertical list of Food Group Category Cards:



Least number of unique categories	Max number of unique categories
Spices and Dry Herbs 15 Ground Cumin Ground Coriander Ground Fennel Ground Mustard Ground Paprika Ground Turmeric Whole Cumin Whole Coriander Whole Fennel Whole Mustard Whole Paprika Whole Turmeric	Spices and Dry Herbs 25 Ground Cumin Ground Coriander Ground Fennel Ground Mustard Ground Paprika Ground Turmeric Whole Cumin Whole Coriander Whole Fennel Whole Mustard Whole Paprika Whole Turmeric
Cooking Products 15 Vegetable Oil Vegetable Shortening Vegetable Stock Vegetable Broth Vegetable Bouillon Vegetable Gravy Vegetable Sauce Vegetable Dressing Vegetable Marinade Vegetable Rub Vegetable Seasoning Vegetable Spice Blend	Cooking Products 25 Vegetable Oil Vegetable Shortening Vegetable Stock Vegetable Broth Vegetable Bouillon Vegetable Gravy Vegetable Sauce Vegetable Dressing Vegetable Marinade Vegetable Rub Vegetable Seasoning Vegetable Spice Blend
Grains 15 Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour	Grains 25 Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour Whole Wheat Flour

Each card includes:

- Large icon (your existing category image)
- Category name
- Total items in stock
- Total weeks of coverage (sum of inventory/consumption)
- Arrow to expand

✦ Expanded Category

Becomes a grid of Inventory Cards:

★ Inventory Card Design

Purpose: show *remaining inventory* + *consumption dynamics*

Top left: item image

Top right: remaining amount (e.g., "1.4 loaves left")

Below:

- "Weeks Coverage: 0.8w"
- "Usage: 2.9 slices/wk"
- "Expires: Feb 14"
- Monthly cost: optional to show small

Color semantics:

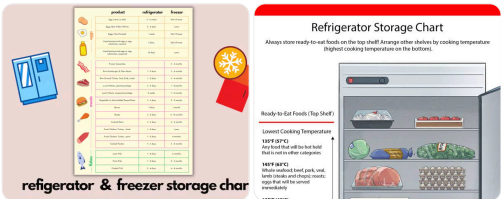
- Green = stable inventory
- Yellow = low
- Red = depleted

The timeline ("week 1, week 2, etc.") stays in the **full-page Inventory Timeline** tab, not the card.

🎯 2. Price Checker Layout

✦ Initial View

A vertical list of Storage Location Category Cards:



Each card includes:

- Storage icon
- Category name
- Number of items with recommended purchase quantities
- Estimated total spend to restock

Example:

Freezer
6 items need restocking

Estimated \$24.18
[Expand]

Much more actionable than your previous headers.

★ Purchase Card (Price Checker Card)

Purpose: show *recommended purchase qty + price comparison*

Top: item image

Name: item name + brand

Need: "Buy 2 packs" (big, bold, colored)

Price:

- Unit price
- Pack price
- Price per month

Store location:

- Stop & Shop
- Walmart
- Mealime import (if relevant)

Optional: show best price store as a tag:

Best Price: Stop & Shop

Below:

A single button:

[View Details]

★ Major UX Difference Between the Two

Here is the core principle:

✓ Inventory Tracker = "STATE"

How much you have & how long it lasts.

✓ Price Checker = "ACTION"

What you should buy & what it costs.

This difference will drive all card content and UI hierarchy.

★ Proposed Unified Bottom Navigation Layout

| Inventory | Price Checker | Meal Planner | Calendar | ☰ | 📁 |

Inventory tab opens → Category cards (food groups) → inventory cards

Price Checker tab opens → Category cards (storage) → purchase cards

They look related but have different content emphasis.

★ Now: Designing Price Checker Around This Framework

Below is your finalized layout for the Price Checker:

★ PRICE CHECKER – FULL UI DESIGN

1. Search + Filter Bar (top)

[🔍 Search items...] [Sort ▼] [Filter ▼] [Show All Items 0/•]

Sorts:

- Lowest price
- Highest price
- Highest need
- Alphabetical

Filters:

- By storage location
- By category

- By price range
- Only on sale

2. Storage Location Category Cards (collapsible)

Examples:

 Freezer
6 items need restocking
Est. Spend: \$12.83
[Expand ▼]

 Pantry
3 items need restocking
Est. Spend: \$5.70
[Expand ▼]

 Bread Cabinet
1 item needs restocking
Est. Spend: \$3.30
[Expand ▼]

You never again show giant blank headers — this looks like a real consumer app.

3. Purchase Card Grid (inside expanded categories)

Three cards per row (auto responsive).

Purchase Card:

[Item Image]
Bread - Pepperidge Farm
Buy 2 packs
\$2.99 per pack
\$0.13/slice • \$6.44/mo
Best Price: Stop & Shop
[View Details]

Colors:

- Red = high need
- Yellow = moderate need
- Gray = optional refill

Zero-need items do NOT display here unless toggled on.

4. Slide-Out Details Panel

Every card button → opens panel with:

- Large image
- Nutrition info (collapsed)
- Price history
- Store comparisons
- Edit item
- Edit category
- Delete item
- Consumption rate
- All underlying metadata

This contains all complexity without crowding the main UI.

★ So, your Price Checker Window should now be designed as:

- ✓ Storage Location Category Cards
- ✓ Purchase Cards inside them
- ✓ Search/filter bar on top
- ✓ Persistent bottom navigation
- ✓ Complex actions placed in the details drawer
- ✓ Zero-need items hidden by default

This creates **consumer-grade clarity** while maintaining your deep functionality.

★ NEXT STEP

Would you like me to create:

1 Visual mockups (Figma-style images) of:

- Price Checker initial view
- Expanded storage category with purchase cards
- Details panel

2 CSS component definitions for:

- Category Cards
- Purchase Cards
- Inventory Cards
- Bottom nav

3 A full-page wireframe you can directly implement?

Which output do you want next?